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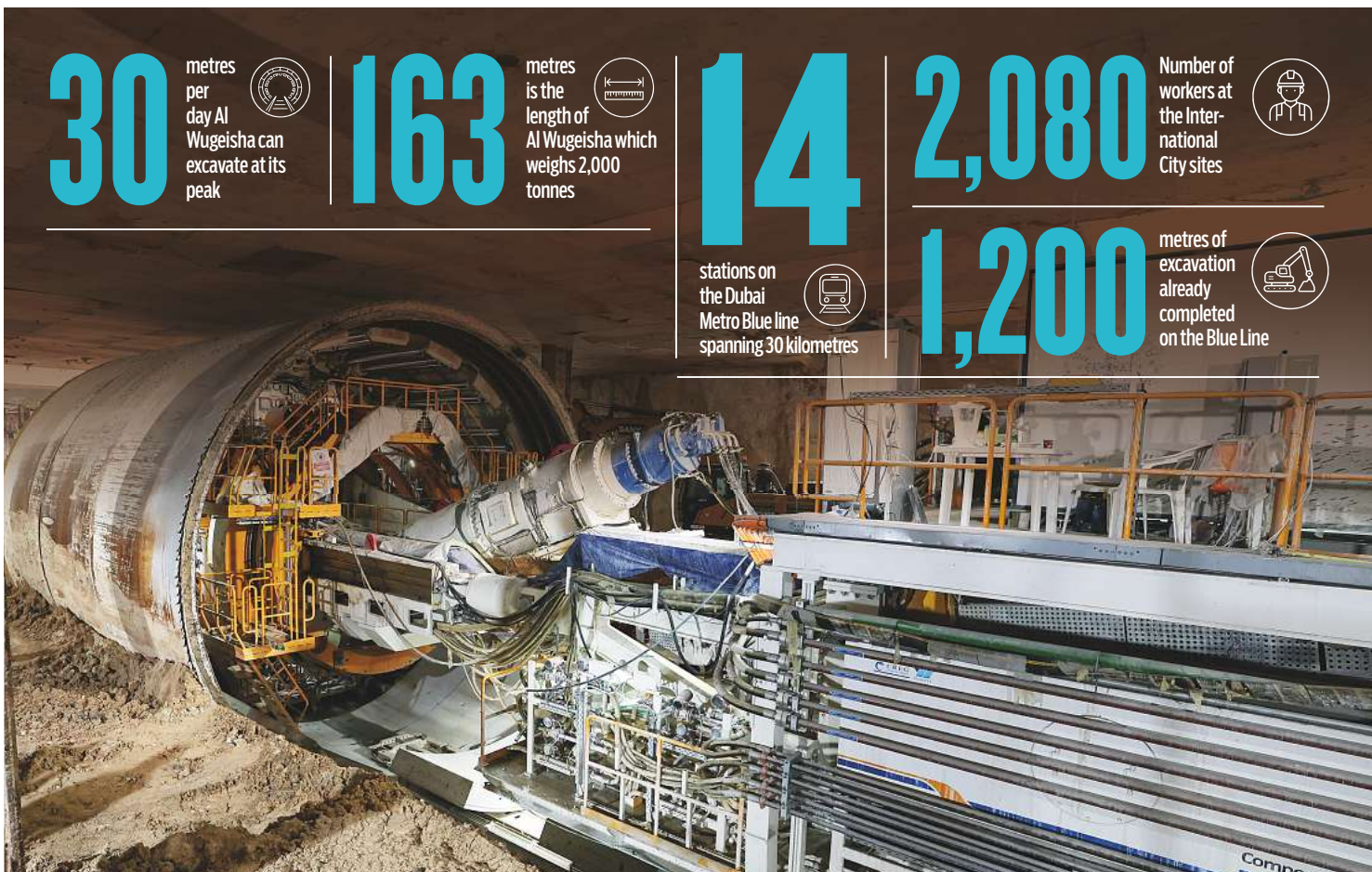
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NEXT-GEN TUNNEL BORING MACHINE SPEEDS UP DUBAI METRO BLUE LINE WORK

■ Work in progress at the Dubai Metro Blue Line next to Dragon Mart in International City-1. The Blue Line is being excavated using Al Wugeisha, a next-generation tunnel boring machine equipped with advanced digital guidance and monitoring systems. The machine can excavate more than double the rate achieved during construction in the initial phases and is more than a conventional tunnel boring machine. It operates as a fully integrated underground production system, capable of excavating, removing soil and automatically installing tunnel lining segments in a continuous process.

SEE ALSO P2

Guggenheim Abu Dhabi to open doors on December 11

ABU DHABI

Gulf News report

Guggenheim Abu Dhabi will welcome its first visitors on December 11 this year.

The museum sits on Saadiyat Island, joining an already crowded field of cultural institutions, with the Louvre Abu Dhabi, the Zayed National Museum, the Natural History Museum Abu Dhabi and teamLab Phenomena Abu Dhabi all within walking distance.



At 80,000 square metres, the museum is enormous by any standard. Interior gallery space totals 11,600 square metres, with another 23,000 square metres set aside for outdoor exhibitions. Visitors will move through 30 galleries connected by a central atrium.

What's likely to draw the most attention, though, are the sculptural cones that punctuate the roofline, nine wrapped in stainless steel mesh, one finished in onyx and glass, some reaching up to 88 metres.

SEE ALSO P4

NETANYAHU HOLDS 'POSITIVE AND PRODUCTIVE' MEETING WITH TRUMP

Leaders sought to patch over public disagreements

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and US President Donald Trump met at the White House yesterday for the first time since they launched a joint war against Iran, offering a chance for Netanyahu to smooth out strains in their relationship.

The closed-door meeting lasted nearly an hour and a half and was "positive and productive," according to White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt. The White House and prime minister's office did not immediately offer more details.

Israel has not taken part in the latest round of hostilities between the United States and Iran, which flared earlier this month as an April ceasefire collapsed.

Iran tops agenda

"We will discuss all the issues on the agenda, first and foremost Iran. Naturally, our goal is to safeguard our security and also to expand the circle of peace around us," Netanyahu had said before departing from Israel. Earlier, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi held separate phone calls on the Strait of Hormuz with his Omani and Saudi counterparts Badr Al-Busaidi and Faisal Bin Farhan, state TV said yesterday.

During the calls, "they stressed the need to strengthen cooperation and advance joint diplomatic efforts to establish stability in the



■ Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, left, meets US President Donald Trump at the White House yesterday.

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region and eliminate the insecurity imposed on the Strait of Hormuz due to the aggressive actions of the United States," the state broadcaster added.

Iran has maintained control over the strait since the start of the Middle East war on February 28, disrupting shipping through the vital conduit.

In recent weeks, fighting has also spread to involve Saudi Arabia and the Iran-backed Houthis rebels in Yemen. The last few days have nonetheless seen a lull in hostilities in the region.

Meanwhile, Oman has pro-

posed a regional mechanism for jointly managing the Strait of Hormuz, according to a Reuters report citing a Gulf source.

No sole control

Under the Omani proposal, which has regional backing, Iran would not exercise sole control of the vital waterway, the source told Reuters.

The plan is said to be modelled on the Strait of Malacca, where users voluntarily contribute fees to help fund navigation, environmental protection, and search-and-rescue operations.

DIFC moves past the 10,000-company mark

AI strategy targets 25,000 jobs and Dh12.9 billion in economic value

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC) has crossed 10,000 active companies for the first time, while its plan to become an AI-native financial centre is expected to create 25,000 jobs and generate Dh12.9 billion in economic value. DIFC had 10,018 active registered companies at the end of the first half of 2026, up 30 per cent over the previous 12 months after 2,318 new firms joined the centre.

The number of regulated financial services companies rose 16 per cent to 1,134, strengthening DIFC's position as the region's largest financial services ecosystem. Growth extended across banking, capital markets, insurance, wealth management and investment businesses during the six-month period.

"DIFC's exceptional performance of surpassing the

10,000 active registered companies for the first time reflects the continued confidence that global financial institutions, investors and innovators place in the Centre's legal and regulatory framework, and its role as a gateway to growth opportunities regionally and globally," said Sheikh Maktoum Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, First Deputy Ruler of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister, Minister of Finance and President of DIFC.

Global centre of gravity

Arif Amiri, Chief Executive Officer of DIFC Authority, said that international companies continued to choose Dubai as a base for regional operations. "Our financial performance for the first six months of 2026 demonstrates that the global centre of gravity for finance continues to shift toward Dubai," Amiri said. "DIFC is the region's only financial centre operating at scale across all sectors, and our ecosystem continues to grow faster and attract more regional offices than the market." The AI plan will underpin DIFC's next phase of wider technology-led expansion in Dubai.

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